

# *The* **No-Fuss** *Batch Cookbook.*

*Simple batch-cooked meals designed to save time, reduce temptation, and make weight loss easier to stick to.*

# Cook once. Eat all week.

*If you've ever stared into the fridge at 6pm wondering what on earth you're going to feed everyone, this book is for you.*

The reason most healthy eating plans fall apart isn't willpower. It's *tired Tuesdays*. It's coming home shattered, opening the freezer, finding nothing, and ordering a takeaway.

Batch cooking is the single biggest game-changer for women trying to lose weight while juggling work, family, and everything else. One afternoon of cooking gives you four or five evenings off and means the easy choice and the healthy choice are finally the same choice.

Inside you'll find 15 of the most popular recipes from our app, chosen because they're forgiving, freeze well, and actually taste like food you want to eat.

**ANNA — THE WEIGHT LOSS ACADEMY**

# A simple Sunday system.

*Batch cooking sounds like a lot of work. It really isn't, once you have a rhythm. Here's the simplest version of how I do it.*

## 01 PICK THREE RECIPES FOR THE WEEK

Choose one slow cooker, one traybake, and one freezer-friendly batch. That gives you variety across the week without it feeling samey.

## 03 SET ASIDE 90 MINUTES ON SUNDAY

Slow cooker on first (it cooks while you prep). Traybake into the oven next. The freezer batch goes in last while you tidy up. You're done.

## 05 LEAN ON YOUR FREEZER

Most batch meals freeze for 3 months. Build a stash of 8–10 portions over a few weeks and you'll never face a "what's for dinner" panic again.

## 02 WRITE A SINGLE SHOPPING LIST

Combine all the ingredients across the three recipes into one shop. A 20-minute job that saves you three trips to the supermarket.

## 04 PORTION AS YOU GO

Cool everything quickly, then portion into reusable containers. Some for the fridge (Mon–Wed), some for the freezer (next week's lifesavers).

# What's Inside.

15 easy to batch recipes.

There are 3 types of recipes: slow cooker, traybakes, and batch & freezer. The veggie ones are marked with a (V).

## SLOW COOKER

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RECIPE 01 • SLOW COOKER

## Slow Cooker Chicken Casserole

*A proper Sunday-feeling dinner – without standing over the hob.*

SERVES

4

TIME

7–8 hrs (low) / 4 hrs (high)

### INGREDIENTS

- 4 chicken fillets, sliced into chunks
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 carrots, peeled and sliced
- 1 celery stalk, sliced
- 640g baby potatoes, halved
- 2 bay leaves
- 2 tsp dried thyme
- 2 tsp dried rosemary
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 2 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- Black pepper, to taste
- 1 chicken stock cube (low sodium)
- 500–750ml boiling water
- 4 tbsp low sodium gravy granules
- 150g peas (fresh or frozen)

### METHOD

- 01 Add all the ingredients except the gravy granules and peas into the slow cooker.
- 02 Start with 500ml of water and only add more if needed. Avoid filling the slow cooker with liquid or covering everything completely – it's not a soup. Chicken releases a lot of liquid as it cooks, so less is more here.
- 03 Stir everything gently until well combined.
- 04 Cover and cook on low for 7–8 hours or high for 4 hours, until the chicken and vegetables are tender.
- 05 About 30 minutes before serving, stir in the gravy granules and peas.
- 06 Taste before serving and adjust seasoning if needed.
- 07 If the casserole looks too liquidy, thicken with a cornflour slurry (1 tbsp cornflour + 1 tbsp water) in the last 30 minutes, or cook with the lid slightly open for 20–30 minutes.
- 08 Serve and enjoy.

#### WLA TIP

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 3 days, or freeze for up to 2 months.



RECIPE 02 • SLOW COOKER

## Slow Cooker Thai Green Curry

*Restaurant-style curry with five minutes of prep.*

SERVES

4

TIME

4 hrs (high) / 6–8 hrs (low)

### INGREDIENTS

- 4 chicken fillets
  - 1 large onion, sliced
  - 1 red pepper, sliced
  - 1 courgette, sliced
  - 130g baby corn
  - 1 tsp garlic powder
  - 1 tsp ground ginger
  - Black pepper, for seasoning
  - 3–4 tbsp curry paste (Thai green)
  - 2 tbsp soy sauce
  - 1 chicken or vegetable stock cube (low sodium)
  - 1 tin coconut milk
- To serve (per portion)*

- 60g wholewheat noodles
- 1 spring onion, finely sliced
- 1 tbsp fresh coriander, chopped (optional)
- Squeeze of lime juice

### METHOD

- 01 Add all ingredients to the slow cooker. Stir well to combine.
- 02 Cover and cook on high for 4 hours or on low for 6–8 hours.
- 03 About 30 minutes before serving, shred or slice the chicken using two forks and return it to the slow cooker.
- 04 Taste test and adjust seasoning or spices if needed.
- 05 Cook the noodles according to the packet instructions.
- 06 To serve, add noodles to a bowl and top with the chicken curry. Sprinkle over the spring onion, coriander (if using) and a squeeze of lime juice.

### WLA TIP

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 3 days, or freeze for up to 2 months.



### RECIPE 03 • SLOW COOKER

## Slow Cooker Katsu Noodles

*All the cosy comfort of katsu — done while you get on with your day.*

#### SERVES

4

#### TIME

6–7 hrs (low) / 3–4 hrs (high)

#### INGREDIENTS

- 1 onion, diced
- 3–4 carrots, peeled and sliced
- 1 red pepper, diced
- 4 chicken fillets, diced
- Black pepper for seasoning
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 heaped tsp curry powder
- 4 tbsp katsu curry paste
- 2 tbsp soy sauce, low sodium
- 1 tin coconut milk
- 1 chicken stock cube, low sodium
- 240g noodles
- 12 tbsp peas

*Serving suggestion (per portion)*

- 1 spring onion, sliced (optional)
- 1 tsp sesame seeds (optional)
- 1 tbsp fresh coriander, chopped (optional)

#### METHOD

- 01 Add the onion, carrots, red pepper and diced chicken to the slow cooker.
- 02 Season with black pepper, then add the garlic powder and curry powder.
- 03 Stir in the katsu curry paste and soy sauce, ensuring everything is well coated.
- 04 Pour in the coconut milk and crumble in the stock cube. Stir gently to combine.
- 05 Place the lid on and cook on low for 6–7 hours or high for 3–4 hours, until the chicken is fully cooked and tender.
- 06 Around 15–20 minutes before serving, cook the noodles according to the packet instructions and cook the peas until tender (or any vegetables of your choice).
- 07 Taste test the curry and adjust seasoning if needed.
- 08 Add the cooked noodles and peas to the slow cooker and mix well. Add a splash of water if needed to loosen the sauce.
- 09 Serve in bowls and top with spring onions, sesame seeds and fresh coriander (all optional).

#### WLA TIP

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 3–4 days, or freeze in portions (without noodles for best texture) for up to 3 months.



RECIPE 04 • SLOW COOKER

## Slow Cooker Sausages + Beans

*Hearty, smoky, and packed with veg – proper comfort food.*

**SERVES**

4

**TIME**

6–7 hrs (low) / 3–4 hrs (high)

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 tsp olive oil
- 8 sausages (pork, beef, chicken/turkey or veggie)
- 1 red pepper, diced
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 celery, diced
- 2–3 carrots, diced
- 1 tin cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 400g potatoes, washed and cubed (skin on)
- Black pepper for seasoning
- 1 heaped tsp garlic
- 1 heaped tsp smoked paprika
- 1 heaped tsp cumin
- 2 tbsp tomato puree
- 2 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tin tinned tomatoes
- 1 low salt stock cube
- 400ml water
- Optional serving suggestion (per portion)*
- 30g grated cheese
- 1 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

### METHOD

- 01 Heat a frying pan with olive oil over a medium heat and cook the sausages until lightly browned on the outside. They do not need to be fully cooked through at this stage. Slice into bite-sized pieces if desired.
- 02 Add the browned sausages to the slow cooker along with the red pepper, onion, celery, carrots, cannellini beans and cubed potatoes.
- 03 Season with black pepper, then add the garlic, smoked paprika and cumin. Stir in the tomato puree, Worcestershire sauce, tinned tomatoes and crumble in the stock cube.
- 04 Pour in the 400ml water, then stir gently so everything is evenly coated.
- 05 Place the lid on the slow cooker and cook on low for 6–7 hours or high for 3–4 hours, until the potatoes are tender and the sausages are fully cooked through.
- 06 Stir well before serving and taste for seasoning.
- 07 Top with cheese and fresh parsley (both optional).

#### WLA TIP

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 4 days, or freeze in single portions for up to 3 months.



RECIPE 05 • SLOW COOKER

## Slow Cooker Mince + Potatoes

*A proper old-school dinner – minimal prep, maximum comfort.*

SERVES

4

TIME

7–8 hrs (low) / 4 hrs (high)

### INGREDIENTS

- 400g minced beef (or pork, turkey, chicken) – or 300g Quorn mince
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 carrots, peeled and sliced
- 1 celery stalk, sliced
- 640g baby potatoes, halved
- 2 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 tsp mixed herbs
- Black pepper, to taste
- 1 beef or vegetable stock cube (low sodium)
- 400ml boiling water
- 4 tbsp low sodium gravy granules
- 240g peas (fresh or frozen)

### METHOD

- 01 Heat a frying pan over medium heat. Add the mince and cook, breaking it up, until browned.
- 02 Drain any excess juice from the mince. Add the mince and all remaining ingredients, except the gravy granules and peas, to the slow cooker.
- 03 Stir everything gently until well combined.
- 04 Cover and cook on low for 7–8 hours or high for 4 hours, until the vegetables are tender.
- 05 About 30 minutes before serving, stir in the gravy granules and peas.
- 06 Taste before serving and adjust seasoning if needed – you can add a little extra gravy granules or seasoning. Remove the bay leaf.
- 07 If the casserole looks too liquidy, thicken it with a cornflour slurry (1 tbsp cornflour + 1 tbsp water) in the last 30 minutes, or cook with the lid slightly open for 20–30 minutes.
- 08 Serve and enjoy.

#### WLA TIP

In a rush? Browning the mince first is optional – you can add it straight to the slow cooker for a quicker version. Store in the fridge for up to 3 days, or freeze for up to 2 months.



RECIPE 06 • TRAYBAKES

## Cheesy Tomato Sausage Traybake

*Comfort food, all on one tray, ready in under an hour.*

SERVES

2

TIME

45 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 280–300g baby potatoes, halved
- 1 onion, sliced
- 1 red pepper, sliced
- 4 sausages (pork, beef, chicken/turkey or veggie)
- 1 tin of chopped tomatoes
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tsp paprika
- 1 tsp oregano or mixed herbs
- ½ tsp garlic powder
- Pinch of black pepper, to taste
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 6 tbsp frozen peas
- 60g cheese, grated
- Portion of vegetables to serve (optional)

### METHOD

- 01 Preheat your oven to 180°C (fan) / 200°C / Gas mark 6.
- 02 Parboil or steam the baby potatoes for 8–10 minutes until just tender, then drain.
- 03 Add the parboiled potatoes, onion, red pepper, sausages, chopped tomatoes, Worcestershire sauce, paprika, herbs, garlic powder, black pepper and olive oil into a large oven dish.
- 04 Mix well and bake for 25–30 minutes, stirring halfway through.
- 05 Add the frozen peas and sprinkle the grated cheese over the top.
- 06 Return to the oven and cook for another 10 minutes, until the cheese is melted and golden.
- 07 Serve with extra vegetables, if desired.

#### WLA TIP

Perfect for batch cooking — just scale up. Add seasonings gradually and adjust to taste. Leftovers keep in the fridge for 3 days or freeze for 2 months.



RECIPE 07 • TRAYBAKES

## Mediterranean Chicken Traybake

*Olives, tomatoes, peppers, and lemony chicken. Holiday vibes on a Tuesday.*

SERVES

1 (easily scaled)

TIME

1 hr

### INGREDIENTS

- ½ tbsp tomato puree
- ½ tbsp harissa paste (or ½ tbsp tomato puree with chilli flakes)
- ½ tbsp olive oil
- 1 chicken fillet, halved
- 160g baby potatoes, halved
- ½ red onion, cut into wedges
- ½ red pepper, cut into chunks
- ½ tsp dried thyme
- ¼ tsp garlic granules (or ½ garlic clove, crushed)
- Black pepper to taste
- ¼ low sodium vegetable stock cube in 60ml boiling water
- ½ tbsp fresh parsley

### METHOD

- 01 Preheat the oven to 180°C fan.
- 02 Mix the tomato puree, harissa and half of the olive oil in a medium bowl. Add the chicken and set aside to marinate for 15–20 minutes.
- 03 Add the baby potatoes, onion and red pepper to a large bowl. Drizzle in the remaining olive oil, add the thyme and garlic, and season with black pepper. Mix well to coat.
- 04 Pour the vegetables onto a large oven tray (with high sides) and arrange evenly. Place the marinated chicken on top.
- 05 Bake for 20–25 minutes.
- 06 Remove the tray from the oven and add the vegetable stock. Stir gently, turn the chicken fillets and return to the oven for a further 20–25 minutes, or until the chicken is cooked through and the vegetables are browned and soft.
- 07 To serve, place the roasted vegetables in a serving bowl, top with the chicken and a sprinkle of parsley.

#### WLA TIP

Easily scaled up — multiply ingredients by however many you're feeding. Use chicken thighs instead of breasts for juicier, more forgiving meat.



RECIPE 08 • TRAYBAKES

## Salmon, Potato & Green Bean Traybake

*A complete dinner on a single tray – high-protein, low-fuss.*

**SERVES**

1 (easily scaled)

**TIME**

35 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 160g potatoes (replace with mixed salad for lunch)
- 1 tsp olive oil
- Black pepper
- 80g courgette
- 1 small onion
- 2 carrots
- 1 small salmon fillet
- 1 tsp lemon juice
- 1 tsp dried mixed herbs

### METHOD

- 01 Preheat oven to 200°C / 390°F / Gas Mark 6. Toss the potatoes in 1 tsp of olive oil. Season with pepper, arrange on a large baking tray and bake for 15 minutes, then remove from the oven.
- 02 While the potatoes are roasting, slice the vegetables and drizzle with a little olive oil and mixed herbs. Season the salmon and squeeze some lemon juice on it.
- 03 Push the potatoes to one side of the baking tray and arrange the salmon and vegetables next to them.
- 04 Bake for another 20 minutes, or until the salmon is cooked through. (If your carrots are big or thick, place them on the tray at the same time as the potatoes.)
- 05 Serve straight from the tray.

**WLA TIP**

Salmon cooks fast – adding it later prevents it from drying out. For a low-carb version, swap the potatoes for a side salad.



RECIPE 09 • TRAYBAKES • VEGETARIAN

## One Tray Harissa Traybake

*Spiced chickpeas, halloumi, and roasted veg with a coriander yoghurt drizzle.*

SERVES

1 (easily scaled)

TIME

35 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- ½ red onion, sliced
- ½ red pepper, sliced
- 6 cherry tomatoes
- ½ courgette, sliced
- 6 tbsp chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- ½ tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp dried thyme
- ½ tsp oregano
- Pinch of black pepper
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 4 tsp harissa paste
- 70g halloumi, sliced
- 3–4 falafels (optional)
- Handful of baby spinach (or rocket)
- Coriander Dressing*
- 1 heaped tbsp full-fat Greek yoghurt
- 1 heaped tsp mayonnaise
- 1 tbsp fresh coriander, chopped

### METHOD

- 01 Preheat the oven to 200°C.
- 02 In a large bowl, add all the ingredients except the halloumi, falafels, spinach and 1 tsp of harissa. Mix until well coated.
- 03 Spread the spiced vegetables and chickpeas on a baking tray and roast for 15–20 minutes, until tender and golden.
- 04 Mix the halloumi with the remaining 1 tsp of harissa.
- 05 Place the halloumi slices on top of the roasted vegetables along with the falafels (if using). Return to the oven for 8–10 minutes, until the halloumi is golden and slightly crisp.
- 06 While the traybake is cooking, mix the dressing ingredients in a small bowl.
- 07 To serve, plate up the traybake, add the spinach (or rocket), then drizzle with the coriander dressing.

#### WLA TIP

Easy to batch cook — just scale up the vegetables, chickpeas and halloumi. Increase harissa, herbs and spices gradually and adjust to taste.



RECIPE 10 • TRAYBAKES

## One Pan Chicken Tikka Tray Bake

*All the flavour of a takeaway, none of the guilt.*

SERVES

2

TIME

1 hr 5 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 2 medium chicken breasts
- 2 tsp curry powder
- 2 tsp olive oil
- 130g brown basmati rice
- 1 courgette, diced
- 1 red pepper, diced
- 1 red onion, sliced
- 2 garlic cloves, crushed
- 2 tbsp tikka curry paste
- 200ml coconut milk
- 100ml chicken stock (low sodium)
- 2 tbsp full-fat Greek yoghurt
- 2 tbsp fresh coriander, finely chopped

### METHOD

- 01 Preheat the oven to 200°C / 180°C fan.
- 02 Add the chicken breasts to a mixing bowl with the curry powder and olive oil. Massage the seasoning into the chicken.
- 03 Add the rice, courgette, red pepper, red onion and garlic to a large ovenproof dish and mix well.
- 04 Top with the tikka paste, coconut milk and stock, and stir well.
- 05 Lay the chicken breasts on top and cover loosely with tin foil.
- 06 Roast for 35 minutes.
- 07 Remove from the oven, take off the foil and bake for a further 10–15 minutes until the chicken is cooked through and the rice is soft.
- 08 If the rice isn't quite cooked, remove the chicken and keep warm in foil while the rice bakes for another 10 minutes.
- 09 Top with a dollop of Greek yoghurt and fresh coriander.

#### WLA TIP

Stores in the fridge for 2–3 days for an easy food prep. Marinate the chicken in the morning if you can — even 30 minutes makes a real difference.



RECIPE 11 • BATCH & FREEZER

## Chilli Con Carne

*The recipe everyone needs in their back pocket.*

SERVES

1 (easily scaled)

TIME

30 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 tsp olive oil
- 120g mince, lean (turkey or beef)
- ½ onion, diced
- ½ clove of garlic, crushed
- ½ pepper, sliced
- 4 mushrooms, sliced
- ½ tsp cumin seeds
- ½ tsp paprika powder
- ½ tsp chilli powder
- ½ stock cube, low sodium (meat or veg)
- 100g passata
- 3 tbsp red kidney beans
- 40g brown rice
- 1 tbsp coleslaw (shop-bought or homemade)
- Side salad of your choice

### METHOD

- 01 In a frying pan, add the olive oil, mince, onions and garlic. Sauté until the mince has browned, then pour off any excess liquid.
- 02 Add the peppers and mushrooms and cook for a further few minutes.
- 03 Add the cumin seeds, paprika, chilli powder and crumbled stock cube. Stir to coat, then add the passata.
- 04 Simmer for 10 minutes.
- 05 Cook the rice according to the packet.
- 06 Make the coleslaw if you're making your own.
- 07 Add the kidney beans to the chilli and cook for a further 5 minutes.
- 08 Taste test and add more seasoning if necessary.
- 09 When the rice is ready, top with chilli and coleslaw, and serve with your choice of side salad.

#### WLA TIP

Always tastes better the next day. Make a triple batch — half for tonight, half for freezer portions that'll save you on the busy nights.



RECIPE 12 • BATCH & FREEZER

## Spaghetti Bolognese

*A proper, slow-cooked ragù – doubled, so half goes in the freezer.*

SERVES

1 (easily scaled)

TIME

30 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 50g spaghetti, wholewheat
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 1 small onion
- ½ clove garlic
- 4 slices of red pepper
- 4 mushrooms
- 130g turkey mince, 2% fat (or 75g Quorn mince)
- 200g canned tomatoes
- 1 tsp tomato puree
- 1 medium carrot
- Sprinkle of black pepper
- 1 tsp mixed herbs
- 30g cheddar cheese

### METHOD

- 01 Cook spaghetti according to packet instructions.
- 02 In a frying pan add the olive oil, onions, garlic, peppers, mushrooms and mince.
- 03 Sauté until the mince has browned (drain off any excess liquid if needed).
- 04 Add the tinned tomatoes, tomato puree and carrots, along with black pepper and mixed herbs.
- 05 Stir and simmer for 15 minutes.
- 06 Taste test before serving and add more seasoning if needed.
- 07 Serve the spaghetti with the bolognese on top and a sprinkle of cheese.

#### WLA TIP

Want it meat-free? Replace turkey mince with 75g Quorn mince. Cook the sauce only, freeze in portions, then cook fresh pasta when you serve.



RECIPE 13 • BATCH & FREEZER

## Beef Tagine

*Slow-braised beef with apricots, cinnamon and warming spices.*

**SERVES**

4

**TIME**

4–5 hrs (high) / 7–8 hrs (low)

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 450g beef pieces, cubed (such as stewing steak)
- 1 red onion, diced
- 4 carrots, diced
- 1 tsp fresh garlic (or powder)
- 1 tsp fresh ginger (or powder)
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp mixed herbs
- Black pepper, to taste
- 1 heaped tbsp tomato purée
- 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- 1 beef or vegetable stock cube (low sodium)
- 100ml boiling water
- 1 bay leaf
- ½ cinnamon stick (or ½ tsp ground cinnamon)
- 50g dried apricots, chopped
- 50g dates, chopped
- 1 tsp cornflour (optional)

*To serve (per portion)*

- 60g couscous
- 100g broccoli, cut into florets
- 1 tbsp flaked almonds
- 1 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped (optional)

### METHOD

- 01 Heat the olive oil in a frying pan over medium heat. Add the beef and sear until browned on all sides.
- 02 Transfer the browned beef to the slow cooker. Add the onion, carrots, garlic, ginger, smoked paprika, turmeric, cumin, mixed herbs, black pepper and tomato purée. Stir until the beef and onion are coated.
- 03 Add the chopped tomatoes, stock cube, water, bay leaf and cinnamon.
- 04 Cook on high for 4–5 hours or low for 7–8 hours, until the beef is tender.
- 05 About an hour before serving, add the apricots and dates.
- 06 About 15 minutes before serving, cook the couscous according to the packet.
- 07 Steam or boil the broccoli until just tender.
- 08 Taste and adjust seasoning. Remove the bay leaf and cinnamon stick.
- 09 For a thicker sauce, mix the cornflour with a splash of water and stir into the tagine until you reach your desired consistency.
- 10 To serve, add the couscous, beef tagine and broccoli to a bowl and sprinkle with flaked almonds and fresh parsley.



RECIPE 14 • BATCH & FREEZER

## Classic Chicken Soup

*The cure-all. Healing, nourishing, and freezes beautifully.*

SERVES

3–4

TIME

40 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 500g packet soup veg (carrot, leeks, celery, parsley)
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp turmeric
- Black pepper, for seasoning
- 1 chicken or vegetable stock cube (low sodium)
- 1–2 tsp miso paste (or soy sauce; optional)
- 800ml water
- 4 chicken fillets (or boneless chicken thighs)

### METHOD

- 01 Heat the olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the soup veg and cook for 5–7 minutes, stirring occasionally, until softened.
- 02 Stir in the garlic powder, turmeric and black pepper. Cook for 1 minute to release the flavours.
- 03 Crumble in the stock cube, miso (if using) and pour in the water. Bring to a gentle simmer.
- 04 Add the chicken fillets (or thighs), cover and cook for 15–20 minutes, until the chicken is cooked through.
- 05 Remove the chicken, shred or chop, and return it to the soup.
- 06 Simmer for a further 5–10 minutes until heated through.
- 07 Taste and adjust seasoning if needed.
- 08 Serve hot.

#### WLA TIP

Stores in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 4 days, or freezes for up to 3 months. Use a whole chicken if you can — the bones make all the difference.



RECIPE 15 • BATCH & FREEZER • VEGETARIAN

## Tikka Red Lentil Soup

*Warming, spiced, packed with plant protein and ready in 30 minutes.*

SERVES

4

TIME

40 mins

### INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1–2 red onions, sliced
- 1 tbsp mango chutney
- Black pepper to taste
- 1 carrot, grated
- 1–2 tbsp tikka curry paste
- 200g red lentils
- 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- 1 vegetable stock cube (low sodium)
- 1 litre water
- To serve (per portion)*
- 1 slice wholemeal bread (or sourdough)
- 30g cheese, grated

### METHOD

- 01 Heat the olive oil in a pan or in the base of your soup maker if it has a sauté function.
- 02 Add the red onions and cook for around 10 minutes until softened and starting to colour.
- 03 Stir in the mango chutney and season with black pepper. Cook for another 3–5 minutes until the onions are dark, sticky and fragrant.
- 04 Add the carrot, tikka paste, red lentils, chopped tomatoes, stock cube and water. Stir well.
- 05 If using a soup maker, use the smooth setting. If using a pan, simmer for 25–30 minutes until the vegetables are tender and the lentils are soft.
- 06 Blend with a stick blender until smooth.
- 07 Transfer to a saucepan and heat through. Add more water to your desired consistency if needed.
- 08 Preheat the grill or air fryer to 180°C. Place the bread on a tray and sprinkle with grated cheese. Grill or air fry for 3–5 minutes until the cheese is melted and lightly golden.
- 09 Taste and adjust seasoning of the soup as needed.
- 10 Serve hot with the cheese on toast on the side.

#### WLA TIP

Add a portion of protein with your soup — 125g Greek yoghurt, 1–2 boiled eggs, or any meat or fish. Add directly to the soup or serve on the side.

# Easy meals. Easier life.

*Batch cooking isn't about being a domestic goddess. It's about giving yourself fewer decisions in a week that already has too many.*

Pick three recipes from this book. Cook them on Sunday. Then notice how much calmer Monday to Thursday feel.

That's the whole game, making the easy choice and the healthy choice.

**ANNA — THE WEIGHT LOSS ACADEMY**